Julia Meshcheryakova

ML Engineer / Data Scientist, 15+ years in IT

ML Engineer with an activist mindset, focusing on projects that improve lives by means of technology and innovation. Starting in 2011 as a full-stack software engineer, I quickly progressed to a Team Lead position. With my strong mathematical and algorithmic background and technical expertise, in 2019, I transitioned into Machine Learning and Data Science. Totals: 20+ completed projects, award-winning innovative solutions with significant commercial and social effect. I'm most inspired by problems that may not have a known solution yet, like the orthodontic CAD system I built. Today I build solutions around models and run the experiments and evaluations on them; next, I want to move from that into research on the models themselves. UK Global Talent Visa holder (on ILR now).

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WORK EXPERIENCE

ML Engineer & Data Scientist, Frontier Company (prev. ISE — Industry Solutions Engineering) — Microsoft 10/2023 - Present · London, UK

- Core focus: agentic systems under strict guardrails, LLM fine-tuning, and evaluating generative systems where no ground truth exists. A feature I implemented for a customer was later adopted into the data-science evaluation framework used across the organisation. Internal engineering excellence award, FY25 Q4.
- Security and Responsible AI: LLM-threat assessments of customer production environments, prompt-injection guardrail research, full risk mapping; escalated and reset a stalling multi-party engagement around a use case all three parties could deliver.
- Technical lead across ~8 end-to-end engagements with key Microsoft customers — pharmaceuticals, healthcare, industrial manufacturing, market research: from problem framing and research, through production deployment, Responsible AI assessment and handover to customer teams. Engagement detail in Projects below.
- Open source & product feedback loop: governance-group member for the RAG Experiment Accelerator (refactored it to increase adoption); converted engagement findings into Azure product-group feature requests and workarounds.

Senior ML Engineer, Member of AI Technical Board and Tech Forum — DataArt (global software engineering firm) 02/2019 - 09/2023 · Voronezh, Russia -> Yerevan, Armenia -> London, UK

- Led ML teams with 7-10 members, responsible for the full development cycle: from the research and solution design to deployment to clouds.
- 10+ completed projects of different sizes, top-3 performer of AI/ML Center of Excellence in 2022: working on business accelerators, interviewing candidates, mentoring, and reviewing trainees.
- Acknowledged contributor to DataArt received the award for innovation by Corporate Vision and Employer Brand in 2020 and was recognised in the Hype Cycle™ for Life Science Clinical Development, 2022 by Gartner®.

Senior .Net Developer, Team / Tech Lead — DataArt 12/2011 - 01/2019 · Voronezh, Russia

- Led distributed teams with 10+ people within product-led companies in finance, travel, and healthcare. Solved complicated architectural challenges, performed task distribution, code review, and junior team members mentoring.
- 6 completed projects from start-up size to big enterprise companies.

Trainee C Developer & Teaching Assistant (Previous Experience) — RELEKS (РЕЛЭКС), Voronezh State University 2010 - 2014 · Voronezh, Russia

- Trainee C developer - conducted research on a memory management algorithm used in DBMS LINTER. Devised approach ~16% more efficient.
- 2y of teaching "Programming in C++" at Voronezh State University.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Agentic framework for a National Healthcare Provider 11/2025 - 05/2026

- Technical lead: designed and delivered an agentic framework for a highly regulated healthcare environment — combining agentic capabilities with strict guardrails, and built to scale across the organisation.
- Led the Responsible AI assessment and full risk mapping; resolved a stalling multi-party engagement by resetting it around a use case all parties could deliver.

Entity extraction & evaluation for reported-case processing, Global Pharmaceutical Company 05/2026 - Present

- Building the experimentation and evaluation pipeline for LLM-based entity extraction from noisy, inconsistently-labelled real-world case reports.
- Designing evaluation that holds up when the reference data itself is dirty — separating model error from label error rather than scoring against an unreliable ground truth.

Agentic oncogenomics research flow for Global Pharmaceutical Company — 3rd place, Microsoft Global Hackathon 2026 09/2026

- 3rd place in the Microsoft Global Hackathon 2026, Executive Challenge for Co-Innovation with Customers; winning project of the Healthcare & Government studio.
- Designed the agent orchestration and engineered the agentic research flow on top of Microsoft Discovery, in a team of four data scientists, three biologists and a technical program manager.
- Aligned the design with computational biologists — mapping their workflows, methods, pain points and expectations onto agent roles and hand-offs.

GraphRAG-powered research assistant for Global Pharmaceutical Company 03/2024 - 09/2025

- Lead the development of Neo4j-based Graph RAG solution turning PubMed into explainable, source-linked insights.
- Developed evaluation criteria for the insights generated, given no ground truth provided.
- Introduced and operationalised the evaluation practice for the engagement.
- Upskilled the customer, providing series of training sessions during the engagement and handover; Lead the RAI assessment of the solution.

Reproducible-research tool for Global Pharmaceutical Company — winning project, Microsoft internal hackathon 03/2026

- Owned the visualisation track: built auditable context sharing between MCP tools and a visualisation tool, and co-developed an integrated dashboard with the customer.
- Proposed and implemented “Git for researchers” — a reproducible research flow with checkpoints to recover and share experiment context. An unassigned idea that became the app’s headline feature.
- Winning project of the internal Microsoft hackathon; presented to customer leadership and fed into a new engagement track.

Parsing receipts with LLM for Global Market Research Leader 09/2024 - 03/2025

- Set up the LLM fine-tuning, evaluation and monitoring pipelines (including custom task-related metrics).
- Raised extraction accuracy 76% → 91% and cut manual effort by 42%, enabling scale across countries, channels and document formats. Internal engineering excellence award, FY25 Q4.
- Integrated model usage into the existing customer solution.
- Devised security assessment of the full customer solution focusing on LLM-connected threats.

Orthodontic CAD system for automating lingual aligners design 02/2019 - 01/2020

- Developed the algorithms for automatic 3D surface segmentation: locating points/areas of interest and topological features (handles), hole filling, and completion of enclosed surfaces - to remove the main bottleneck for scaling.
- Created detailed documentation of algorithms for patents registration.
- Dental Products Report included the app in the top-5 software products of 2020; in December 2021, company received 510(k) FDA clearance for the app.
- The company grew to 5000+ patients treated in 1y after the automated version release.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Top Skills: Machine Learning, Data Science, .Net, Team/Tech Leadership, Public Speaking, Mentorship

Data-science and ML: Classical ML, Neural networks (incl. RNNs), NLP, LLM, Computer Vision, Transformer architectures, Fine-tuning and LoRA, Multi-agent systems

Programming and Markup Languages: Python, C#, T-SQL, JS, Typescript, C++, HTML, XML, CSS, C

Technologies and Frameworks: NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, spaCy, sk-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenCV, Google OR-Tools, MS .NET Framework and .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC and Core, Angular, TypeScript, jQuery, Microsoft Discovery

Clouds: MS Azure, AWS

Databases: MS SQL Server, Neo4j, MongoDB, Redis, Snowflake

EDUCATION

Postgraduate, Master's and Bachelor's degree in Applied Mathematics and CS
Voronezh State University (Russia) · 2007 - 2016

COURSES

AI Performance Engineering (4-month course) 03/2026 - 06/2026
Nebius Academy · LLM architectures and neural networks (transformers, fine-tuning and LoRA), AI agents, MLOps, performance engineering (speculative decoding, quantization, CUDA kernels), and LLM post-training, from SFT to RL.

LANGUAGES

English: Full Professional Proficiency

Russian: Native

CONFERENCES & TALKS

Security-insights forum — internal, Microsoft 2025
Authored and presented an LLM-threat security assessment (actors, threats, mitigations) for a customer's production environment.

Security Day workshop: Cutting Corners Hero — internal, Microsoft 2026
Built and delivered a gamified workshop on secure-by-design trade-offs for LLM systems at a Security Day across the Frontier Company organisation; strong feedback, accepted for internal security training and being scaled across teams.

Data Science Europe 11/2022
Presented DataArt AI&ML CoE expertise. Attracted dozens of candidates and several clients.

PUBLICATIONS

Superbacteria: The War We're Going to Lose Without AI and Big Data
Julia Meshcheryakova, Denis Tomilin · August 16, 2023 · healthcarebusinesstoday.com

Holiday Season: Predicting and Tolerating High Load in Business - Dealing With Unexpected Anomalies
Julia Meshcheryakova · January 11, 2023 · hackernoon.com

The Relevance of Cloud-Based Technologies in Modern Manufacturing
Julia Meshcheryakova, Max Ivannikov · October 20, 2022 · iotforall.com - top search result in google on topic. Published in computer-automation.de as "Die Bedeutung von Cloud-basierten Technologien in der modernen Fertigung".

COMMUNITY & MENTORING

Dev Academy mentor & AI Learning Day — Microsoft (internal) 2024 - 2026
Mentor in Microsoft's Dev Academy: 6 sessions across the Engineer and Data Science tracks (~30 engineers Microsoft-wide), 2 hands-on AI Learning Day labs, and a 17-engineer study group building LLMs from scratch.

Top Active Community Member — StackOverflow 05/2013 - Present
~180k people reached, 70 badges, 3200+ reputation.

Mentor in Machine Learning — TechLeaders (mentors program) 09/2020 - 12/2020 · Voronezh, Russia
Created an experimental program for Machine Learning that was then accepted as ML internship program for graduates at DataArt.

Ambassador — IT-Cup (intellectual games tournament in the IT industry) 09/2012 - 09/2019 · Voronezh, Russia
Organised the tournament in 2012, 2013, 2014, 2015, 2016, 2017, 2019.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Founder & sole engineer, Quizrun (quizrun.org): A hybrid sport I co-invented: a running event where lateral-thinking puzzles solved en route subtract time from your finish. 500+ participants from 60+ cities in 20+ countries so far. Built solo, agent-assisted, applying production engineering practice from the first commit: React/TypeScript + Vite, Supabase/Postgres with row-level security and role-based access, CI with gated database migrations, staging and production on Cloudflare. Covers registration, scoring, track analysis, messaging and an analytics dashboard for organisers.

Food Enough (food-enough.pages.dev): Your lens on any menu: scan it in any language, see what you can actually eat, then get help choosing. It grew from my own pain as a picky eater with choice paralysis. In development, shipping soon.

CogniRun: Extending the Quizrun engine into a mass-participation platform — turning run-and-solve data into population-level insight on how people reason under physical load. In active development.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

IT-support, coordinator, full-stack contributor — eco-dvor & eco-taxi (vrn) & etonemusor.ru 03/2020 - 03/2023 · Voronezh, Russia -> Yerevan, Armenia
Non-commercial projects, providing citizens with a way to recycle their waste and educating them.

- Automated coordinators' workflows for route planning and stats, cutting single-run time by 30%. Assembled an e-map with mobile points and contacts.
- Integrated external data from 5+ eco-projects, adding 100+ points to etonemusor.ru map. Delivered 10+ feature proposals, built e-map with contact data.
- Created auto-generated 1-page waste classification memo and authored 20+ educational posts.
- Scaled project from 15 -> 50 mobile points; the ecodvor community reached 5k, and finally, the commercial recycling company launched in Voronezh.